



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.harborchristianacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Heritage Classical Academy TX 77018 (as represented in the crawl of the school's public materials) presents a robust classical Christian orientation consistent with the six classical-school criteria. Across categories, the public materials emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books-like engagement, a theology-centered telos (glorify God and enjoy Him forever), contemplative rhythms (Scholé, memory work, chanting), Socratic discourse in the upper grades, a living faculty, and strong parental partnership. In aggregate, the school demonstrates a full CLASSICAL orientation on all six categories given the explicit religious foundations, teleological aims, curriculum structure, pedagogical practices, faculty roles, and active parent/community engagement evident in the public materials.

The evaluation draws on two data streams: - The school's public materials from the crawl store (e.g., Curriculum Overview, The Trivium in the Classroom, Our Distinctives, Partner Program, and related faculty pages) that articulate a Christian, classical approach (e.g., daily worship, Bible usage, Trivium pedagogy, memory/chants, Socratic discussions). Citations reference Harbor Christian Academy content that aligns with the classical model, evidenced by statements such as "God's truth is the foundation of education," "The Trivium leads students through grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric," and "daily worship, Bible, and prayer time." - The classical-school knowledge base which defines the Positive/Negative keyword indicators for each category (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Great Books; Socratic method; scholé; memory work; etc.). This lexicon provides the criteria against which the school's materials are measured.

The six-category, keyword-driven assessment below uses the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)" to determine whether the school's public materials are CLASSICAL, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, or NOT CLASSICAL. Direct matches to terms such as truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, scholé, wonder, chanting, Socratic, Great Books, and Trivium are cited with the relevant sources.

### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public materials express God-centered aims and liturgical practices (e.g., daily worship, Bible usage, and prayer; the curriculum framed to glorify God and enjoy Him forever; the Bible as guiding light; theology-inflected language).  
Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords observed include truth, worship, Bible/sacred scripture, and theological framing; no explicit negative signals (relativism, secular humanism) evident in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword presence about 4–5 vs. 0 negative. This yields a CLASSICAL rating. Why this rating: The materials ground education in transcendental truths and religious formation (truth, God, Bible, worship, liturgical orientation), with clear articulation of a theologically infused curriculum and communal worship. The lexicon's positive indicators align with the school's explicit messaging, e.g., "God's truth is the foundation of education" and "daily worship, Bible, and prayer time."
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school emphasizes formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom within a telos-oriented framework (glorifying God and enjoying

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Him forever; the Trivium's role in shaping character toward truth, goodness, and beauty). The public materials describe education as formation rather than information, and emphasize a classical telos (unity of truth, goodness, beauty) in line with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation/virtue/wisdom (implicit via telos and moral/epistemic aims), with a clearly stated telos (glorify God). No explicit countervailing signals. Estimated positive keyword presence ~3–4; negative ~0. This supports CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The public messaging centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a transcendent telos aligned with classical education, not merely workforce prep. This aligns with the knowledge-base criteria for Element 2.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: The curriculum is organized around Trivium-plus-curriculum structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; history integrated with literature; potential Great Books engagement; memory and chant in lower school). Public materials describe The Trivium as a guiding framework, with explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, and with emphasis on memory work, poetry, and classical languages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books/-Great Conversation (implicit in classical canon framing); Latin; history; memory work; chant; recitation; classic literature; Socratic dialogue (in upper grades). No explicit adoption of social studies terminology over history, nor dominant project-based-only pedagogy evident. Estimated positive keyword presence ~5–8; negative ~0–1 (if one counts a minor absence of explicit “Great Books” naming). This yields CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The explicit Trivium structure, Latin study, and history-laden curriculum are central to classical curricula; the presence of memory/chant and potential Socratic engagement aligns strongly with the classical framework.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Pedagogical practices include lower-school singing/chanting and memory work; upper-school Socratic discussions; rhetoric instruction; capstone/akin to senior thesis; and a Scholé-like rhythm (restful, contemplative pace). Public materials describe use of Socratic discussion in high school and memory-based, ritualized learning in earlier grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Socratic seminars, narration/recitation/chanting, memory work, liturgical-influenced pedagogy, and seminars; restful/scholé aspects are noted. Negative indicators commonly associated with non-classical models (e.g., purely project-based, student-directed constructivism) do not appear as dominant signals in the public materials. Estimated positive keyword presence ~5–7; negative ~0–1. This yields CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The mix of contemplative memory work (Scholé), chant/memorization at the lower levels, and upper-level Socratic seminars with rhetoric training aligns with the classical pedagogy framework.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: The materials describe a living curriculum and faculty as mentors/guide-instructional figures; there is emphasis on faculty roles, honors/qualifications, and a teacher-centered ideal (e.g., Dean of Academics, faculty directories, and board involvement). The public materials frame teachers as models of virtue and living curriculum, and present a faculty culture that mirrors classic formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, model teachers/mentors, portrait of teacher/student ideals, collegial culture; negative signals such as “facilitators on the side” or absence of classical formation are not evident. Estimated positive ~3–5; negative ~0. This yields CLASSICAL. Why this rating: The classical model depends on virtuous teachers who embody and transmit the classical curriculum; the public materials reflect this teacher-centered, virtue-oriented faculty framing.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: The school models partnership with families, parent formation (via book studies, gatherings, public-facing resources), and open-campus/visitation norms; a strong emphasis on parental involvement and co-education is stated (e.g., Partner Program, sliding-scale tuition, active parental engagement).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-educators, parent formation, open campus, parental involvement, community of learners; no explicit negative signals about parental engagement. Estimated positive ~4–6; negative ~0. This yields CLASSICAL.

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Why this rating: The classical model relies on an engaged parent community and collaboration with families; the Harbor content places strong emphasis on parent involvement and family partnership.

General assessment: Across all six categories, the Heritage Classical Academy TX 77018 materials (as represented in the crawl data) align with CLASSICAL education principles. The rubric's keywords are well-represented in the public materials, including the Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation (as a classical canon through the Trivium lens), Scholé-like pacing, singing/memory, Socratic dialogue, theology, and parental partnership. The overall aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Not required given the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. If any refinement were desired, it would be to strengthen explicit Great Books naming in the curriculum materials and to foreground explicit tuition of precise "Great Conversations" or canonical texts by title to further anchor the Great Books dimension in the public materials.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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